Strategic Partnership Proposal

King Abdulaziz University

National Preprint Platform & Research Excellence Initiative

Executive Summary

THE CHALLENGE

Saudi Arabia's research reputation has been significantly damaged by high-profile retractions and citation manipulation scandals. The Kingdom lacks national preprint infrastructure and standardised research integrity frameworks aligned with international best practices.

THE SOLUTION

A strategic partnership to establish Saudi Arabia's first national preprint platform with KAU as anchor institution—rebuilding international credibility through world-class research integrity infrastructure.

STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

01

Establish Saudi Arabia's first national preprint platform

02

Position KAU as the academic anchor for research integrity

03

Create Vision 2030-aligned research infrastructure

04

Build local capacity for sustainable publishing excellence

05

Rebuild and enhance Saudi Arabia's international research reputation

Three-Track Engagement Model

A structured partnership with clearly defined responsibilities—maximizing KAU's academic involvement while protecting from technology investment risk.

TRACK 1

Technology Stack

Investment-intensive software infrastructure including preprint server, AI integrity tools, and manuscript workflows.

- Preprint server platform
- AI integrity tools
- Manuscript workflows
- Global discovery network

LEAD

Waraqa Technology

KAU: Platform user only

TRACK 2

Platform Operations

Day-to-day managerial functions ensuring quality, author support, and researcher engagement.

- Metadata quality assurance
- Author help desk
- Production services
- Researcher outreach

LEAD

Waraqa + Inspiring STEM

KAU: Submission contributor

TRACK 3

Editorial Governance

Academic leadership providing scientific credibility and research integrity oversight.

- Editorial oversight
- Peer reviewer networks
- Research integrity
- Scientific advisory

LEAD

King Abdulaziz University

Central backbone role

Track 1: Technology Stack

100% Waraqa Investment

Investment-intensive software infrastructure—the technical foundation enabling modern research sharing and integrity validation.

LEAD PARTNER

Waraqa Technology

With external technology investment

KAU ROLE

Client and platform user only.

TECHNOLOGY COMPONENTS

Preprint Server Platform

ScienceOpen-powered with Arabic language support

AI Integrity Tools

SciScore, plagiarism detection, image analysis

Manuscript Workflows

Automated submission, review, publication systems

Global Discovery Network

ScienceOpen's 100+ million article network

Track 2: Platform Operations

Waraqa + Inspiring STEM

Day-to-day managerial and operational functions ensuring quality, author support, and researcher engagement across the platform.

LEAD PARTNERS

Waraqa Publishing

With Inspiring STEM as operations partner

KAU ROLE

Supporting research institution contributing submissions and promoting platform adoption.

OPERATIONAL SERVICES

Metadata Quality Assurance

Waraqa Operations Team ensuring indexing excellence

Author Help Desk

Full Arabic/English bilingual support for researchers

Production & XML Services

Discovery STM / Waraqa typesetting and formatting

Outreach & Engagement

Waraqa with KAU promotion support to researchers

Track 3: Editorial & Scientific Governance

KAU LEADS

CENTRAL BACKBONE ROLE

Academic leadership including editorial oversight, peer reviewer networks, research integrity committees, and scientific advisory boards.

INSPIRING STEM SUPPORT

Governance framework development, COPE/ICMJE compliance protocols, editorial best practices training.

KAU LEADERSHIP RESPONSIBILITIES

Editorial Leadership

Section editors from KAU faculty across disciplines

Peer Review Network

Access to KAU's international reviewer database

Research Integrity Committee

Committee membership and oversight protocols

Journal Integration

Existing KAU journals as platform launch partners

Partnership Value Proposition

CONTRIBUTION

What KAU Provides

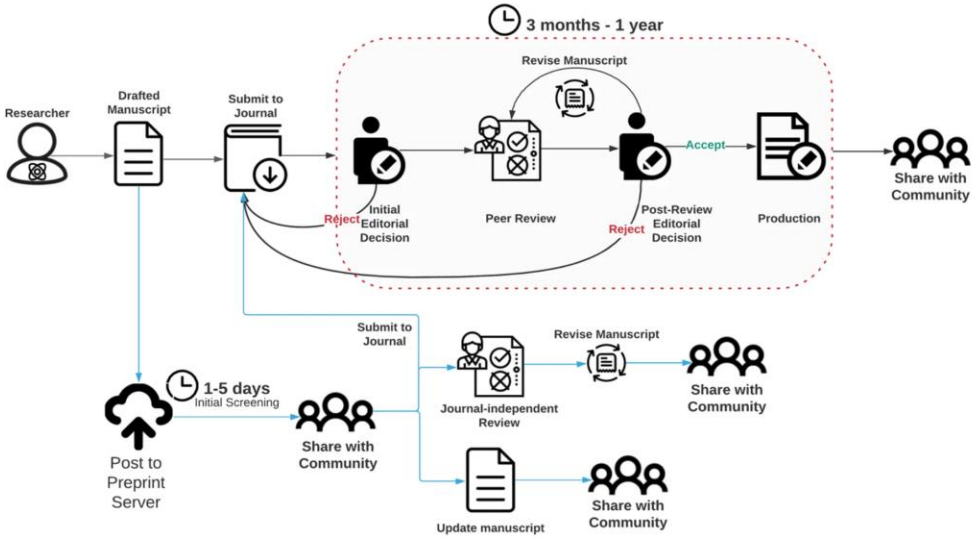
- Institutional Recognition — Official university endorsement
- Academic Accreditation — University backing for quality
- Editorial Resources — Faculty for editorial boards
- Research Integrity Leadership — Committee oversight
- Journal Portfolio — Existing journals for integration
- Researcher Pipeline — Faculty and student submissions

BENEFIT

What KAU Receives

- National Leadership Position — Anchor institution status
- Enhanced Research Visibility — International discoverability
- Research Integrity Infrastructure — World-class tools
- International Standards — COPE, ICMJE compliance
- Training & Capacity Building — Professional development
- Vision 2030 Contribution — National impact

National Preprint Platform



Traditional Journal (3-12 months) vs Preprint Server (1-5 days)

KEY WORKFLOW ADVANTAGES

1-5 days

vs 3-12 months traditional review

Immediate Community Sharing

Research available globally upon posting

Journal-Independent Review

Open peer review separate from journals

Continuous Improvement

Authors update based on feedback

Dual Pathway Option

Rejected manuscripts still shared

Platform Features & Research Integrity

PLATFORM CAPABILITIES

AI-Driven Pre-Screening
Automated quality assessment

Open Peer Review
Transparent evaluation in Arabic/English

SciScore Integration
Methodology rigor assessment

Global Discovery
100+ million article network

Bilingual Interface
Full Arabic and English support

RESEARCH INTEGRITY FRAMEWORK

PRIORITY ABOVE ALL METRICS

In response to recent international challenges to Saudi research reputation, the platform prioritizes research integrity as its foundational principle.

- Zero tolerance for publication misconduct
- COPE/ICMJE compliance frameworks
- Ethical citation with self-citation monitoring
- Transparent QA with continuous improvement
- KAU Committee oversight and leadership

12-Month Implementation Timeline

MONTHS 1-3

Foundation

- MoU finalization
- Governance structure
- Platform specs
- Editorial recruitment

KAU ACTION

Sign MoU, nominate board

MONTHS 4-6

Development

- Platform build
- Arabic adaptation
- Training curriculum
- Reviewer network

KAU ACTION

Provide faculty, recruit reviewers

MONTHS 7-9

Soft Launch

- Beta launch
- Initial submissions
- QA testing
- Process refinement

KAU ACTION

Submit preprints, test workflows

MONTHS 10-12

Full Launch

- Public launch
- Outreach
- National promotion
- Performance monitoring

KAU ACTION

Promote platform, lead governance

Governance Structure

STRATEGIC OVERSIGHT

Steering Committee

KAU: VP Research

Waraqa: Dr. Theeb Alkahtani

Inspiring STEM: Martin Delahunty

KAU CHAIRED

Editorial Advisory Board

Senior KAU faculty

Multi-disciplinary reps

International advisors

KAU LED

Research Integrity Committee

Ethical oversight

Misconduct investigation

COPE/ICMJE compliance

OPERATIONAL FOUNDATION

Waraqa National Preprint Platform

Strategic Alignment: Vision 2030

VISION 2030 TRANSFORMATION OBJECTIVES

Knowledge Economy Leadership

Position Kingdom as Middle East's premier scientific publishing hub

Research Excellence Infrastructure

Build world-class systems for research validation

International Reputation

Rebuild Saudi Arabia's standing in global research

Human Capital Development

Build local capacity for sustainable excellence

KAU STRATEGIC PLAN ALIGNMENT

RESEARCH LEADERSHIP

Anchor institution role establishes KAU as the Kingdom's foremost research governance authority

INTERNATIONAL VISIBILITY

Global discoverability through 100+ million article network and indexing partnerships

NATIONAL PARTNERSHIP

Template for collaboration with other Saudi universities building unified infrastructure

Next Steps & Recommendation

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS

1. Presidential endorsement of partnership principles
2. Designate KAU leadership for Steering Committee
3. Schedule MoU negotiation meeting with Waraqa
4. Identify initial editorial board candidates

KAU COMMITMENT

- ✓ Editorial and scientific governance leadership
- ✓ Research integrity committee oversight
- ✓ Faculty participation in editorial boards
- ✓ Peer reviewer network access
- ✓ Platform promotion to researchers

RECOMMENDATION

Proceed with MoU negotiation to establish KAU as Saudi Arabia's anchor institution for research integrity and preprint infrastructure.

Waraqa and Inspiring STEM provide full technology investment and operational management.

THANK YOU

Let's Build the Future of Saudi Research Together

WARAQA PUBLISHING HOUSE

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